On top of that, the example included in this chapter makes extensive use of the following:

- Automating cloud infrastructure with CloudFormation (chapter 4)

18.1 Why should you consider containers instead of virtual machines?

Containers and virtual machines are similar concepts. This means you can apply your knowledge gained from previous chapters to the world of containers. As shown in figure 18.1, both approaches start with an image to spin up a virtual machine or container. Of course, differences exist between the technologies, but we will not discuss them here. As a mental model, it helps to think of containers as lightweight virtual machines.

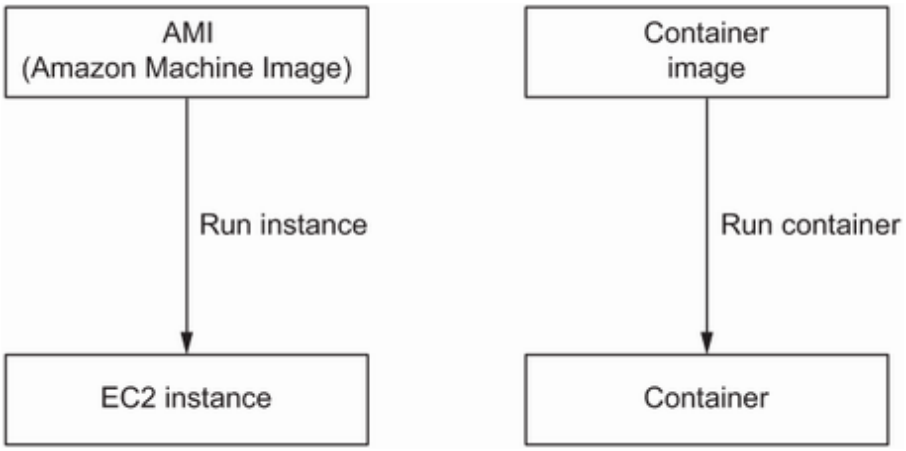


Figure 18.1 From a high-level view, virtual machines and containers are similar concepts.